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Danteshwari Temple

Danteshwari Temple is Hindu temple, dedicated to Goddess Danteshwari, and is one of the 52 Shakti Peethas, shrines of Shakti, the divine feminine, spread across India. The temple built in the 14th century, is situated in Dantewada, a town situated 80 km from Jagdalpur Tehsil, Chhattisgarh. Dantewada is named after the Goddess Danteshwari, the presiding deity of the earlier Kakatiya rulers. Traditionally she is the *Kuldevi* (family goddess) of Bastar state,[1][2][3]

The temple is as according legends, the spot where the *Daanth* or Tooth of Sati fell, during the episode when all the Shakti shrines were created in the *Satya Yuga*.

Every year during Dusshera thousands of tribals from surrounding villages and jungles gather here to pay homage to the goddess, when her idol was taken out of that ancient Danteshwari temple and then taken around the city in an elaborate procession, now a popular tourist attraction part of the 'Bastar Dussehra' festival.[4][5] There also a is tradition of lighting Jyoti Kalashas during Navaratris here.

Danteshwari Temple	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Bastar
Deity	Danteshwari (Shakti)
Location	
Location	Dantewada
State	Chhattisgarh
Country	India

Location in Chhattisgarh

Legend

It is believed that a tooth of Sati had fallen here and Danteshwari Shakti Peetha was established. According to the ancient legend, Goddess Sati committed self-immolation in the fire pit of yagna kund, due to an insult committed by her father Daksha towards her consort Lord Shiva during the Yagna. Raged by the death of Sati, Shiva destroyed the Yagna of Daksha and with the body of Sati in his hands started to do 'Taandav'. Lord Vishnu cut the dead body of Goddess Sati with his Sudarshan Chakra to free Lord Shiva from the grief caused by her death. Parts of the dead body of Goddess Sati were scattered to fifty-two different places, which were consecrated as Shakti Pithas.

Architecture

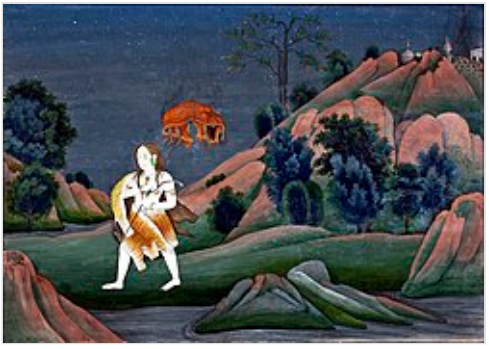
The Danteshwari temple was built in the 14th Century. The idol of Danteshwari Mai is chiseled out of black stone. The temple is divided into four parts such as Garbh Griha, Maha Mandap, Mukhya Mandap and Sabha Mandap. Garbha Griha and Maha Mandap were constructed with stone pieces. There is a Garuda Pillar in front of the entrance of the temple. The temple itself is located in a spacious courtyard surrounded by massive walls. The shikhara is adorned with sculptural finery.

Danteshwari Temple (India)

Coordinates	
Architecture	
Type	Hindu temple architecture
Completed	14th century
Website	
www.maadanteshwari.in (https://www.maadanteshwari.in)	

Danteshwari temple Jagdalpur

Danteshwari Temple is the centre of the famous Bastar Dussehra. The devotion of locals, as well as tribals, is intricately linked to the presiding deity of Bastar. Unlike the idol of the goddess in Dantewada which is black in color, this idol is white.



Shiva carrying the corpse of Dakshayani

See also

- List of Hindu temples in India
- Tamda Ghumar
- Chitrakote Falls
- Kotumsar Cave
- Mendri Ghumar
- Kanger Ghati National Park
- Indravati National Park

Danteswari Temple Jagdalpur

References

1. Chisholm, Hugh, ed. (1911). "Bastar" (https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/1911_Encyclop%C3%A6dia_Britannica/Bastar). *Encyclopædia Britannica*. Vol. 3 (11th ed.). Cambridge University Press. p. 499.
2. History of the temple (http://www.dantewada.nic.in/history_temple.htm) Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20171020194954/http://dantewada.nic.in/history_temple.htm) 20 October 2017 at the Wayback Machine Dantewada district Official website.
3. Danteshwari Temple (https://web.archive.org/web/20100923203939/http://chhattisgarhtourism.net/reasons_to_visit/danteshwari_temple.htm) Chhattisgarh State Tourism, Official

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4. Danteshwari Temple (http://www.india9.com/i9show/-Chhattisgarh/Danteshwari-Temple-14030.htm)
5. Celebration in tribal land (https://web.archive.org/web/20040117081905/http://www.hindu.com/thehindu/mag/2003/12/14/stories/2003121400210800.htm) The Hindu, Dec 14, 2003.

Goddess Danteswari

External links

- Danteshwari-temple (http://wikimapia.org/3382672/et/Maa-Danteshwari-temple) at *wikimapia*
- Danteshwari Temple (https://templeknowledge.com/danteshwari-temple/)

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